(2400) and the United States (1500).[67] Such current figures do not, however, preclude the wider argument in India's economic diplomacy that the country is still developing its innovative potential and that its economic culture of pluralism will prove more self reliant and sustainable in the long run. Together with India's demographic dividend, which is still being explored, the Indian government is thus implementing a variety of missions "to foster a culture of innovation and entrepreneurship in the country."[68] For S. Jaishankar, this has important foreign policy implications, illustrated by the perception of India as a hub for information technology (IT) serving as the "most effective achievement" of soft power.[69] It also allows for new partnerships, for example, with Japan, which offers "a unique combination of political, economic, technological and cultural synergies" that he identifies as compatible with India's model of innovation.[70]

India's focus on technology and innovation as diplomatic tools to enhance India's prestige and power abroad is also manifested at the global level. For example, by leading the International Solar Alliance in partnership with France, India highlights its commitment to find new solutions to foster cleaner energy.[71] At the regional level, on the other hand, this focus is reflected in New Delhi's successful launch of a South Asian satellite, which enhanced regional cooperation with its neighbours on technical and cultural issues, such as tele-medicine and education.[72]

Conclusion: domestic and external challenges